

Project Design Phase

Problem – Solution Fit Template

Date	03 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-4228
Project Name	Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Problem – Solution Fit

The proposed ServiceNow solution addresses the problem of efficiently and accurately importing structured employee data received in spreadsheet format. Instead of manually entering records into the destination table, the system uses an Import Set as an intermediate staging area and a Transform Map to map source fields to the appropriate target fields. The transformed records can then be validated in the target table.

Purpose

- Reduce the time and effort required for bulk employee-data entry.
- Improve consistency by mapping spreadsheet fields to the corresponding ServiceNow fields.
- Reduce duplicate records by using Coalesce with a suitable unique identifier such as Employee ID.
- Provide an intermediate staging layer where imported data can be handled before reaching the target table.
- Provide reports and a dashboard for visibility into employee records and data distribution.

1. Problem Statement

Organizations frequently receive employee information in Excel or similar spreadsheet files. Manually copying this information into a ServiceNow database table is time-consuming and can introduce typing errors, incorrect field mapping, inconsistent values, and duplicate records. Repeated imports are particularly difficult to manage when existing employee records need to be updated rather than inserted again. A controlled and repeatable import process is therefore required to move spreadsheet data into ServiceNow while maintaining data integrity.

2. Target Audience & Stakeholders

- **System Administrators:** Manage ServiceNow tables, imports, Transform Maps, and data integrity.
- **HR or Administrative Teams:** Work with employee records and require accurate, up-to-date information.
- **Database/Data Operations Personnel:** Handle bulk data migration and recurring spreadsheet imports.
- **Business Users/Department Leads:** Depend on reliable employee information and summarized reports.

3. Problem–Solution Fit Matrix

Identified Pain Point	Proposed System Capability	Business Value & Outcome
Time-consuming manual data entry	Bulk Spreadsheet Ingestion using ServiceNow Import Sets	Loads structured spreadsheet data into a staging table, reducing repetitive manual entry.
Format mismatch and field-mapping errors	Automated and Custom Field Mapping through Transform Maps	Maps source columns to target fields consistently and reduces field-alignment mistakes.
Duplicate employee records during repeated imports	Coalesce-based record matching	Uses a unique identifier such as Employee ID to update existing records instead of creating duplicates.
Risk of writing raw or incorrect data directly into the target table	Intermediate Import Set staging layer	Provides a controlled staging area before transformation into the Employee Test target table.

Identified Pain Point	Proposed System Capability	Business Value & Outcome
Limited visibility into imported employee information	Reports and Employee Analytics Dashboard	Provides department-wise, location-wise, and list-based views for centralized monitoring.

4. Summary of Fit

The Import Data Using Transform Maps solution directly addresses the operational difficulties of managing employee data received through spreadsheets. The workflow uses an Import Set Table as a staging layer, a Transform Map for controlled source-to-target mapping, and Coalesce to distinguish new records from existing records during repeated imports. The resulting employee data can be validated in the target table and presented through reports and an Employee Analytics Dashboard. This provides a structured, repeatable approach for spreadsheet-based employee data management in ServiceNow.

References

1. ServiceNow project reference: Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet) — provided project documentation.
2. Project reference document: Project Design Phase – Module 1: Problem Solution Fit — provided for reference.
3. Template: Project Design Phase – Problem – Solution Fit Template v1 — used as the documentation format.